



60 Extra Large,
Please



72 Roast 'em
Good



80 Clicks 'n' Keys

Digital Tools

Technology For Personal And SoHo Productivity

Enhance

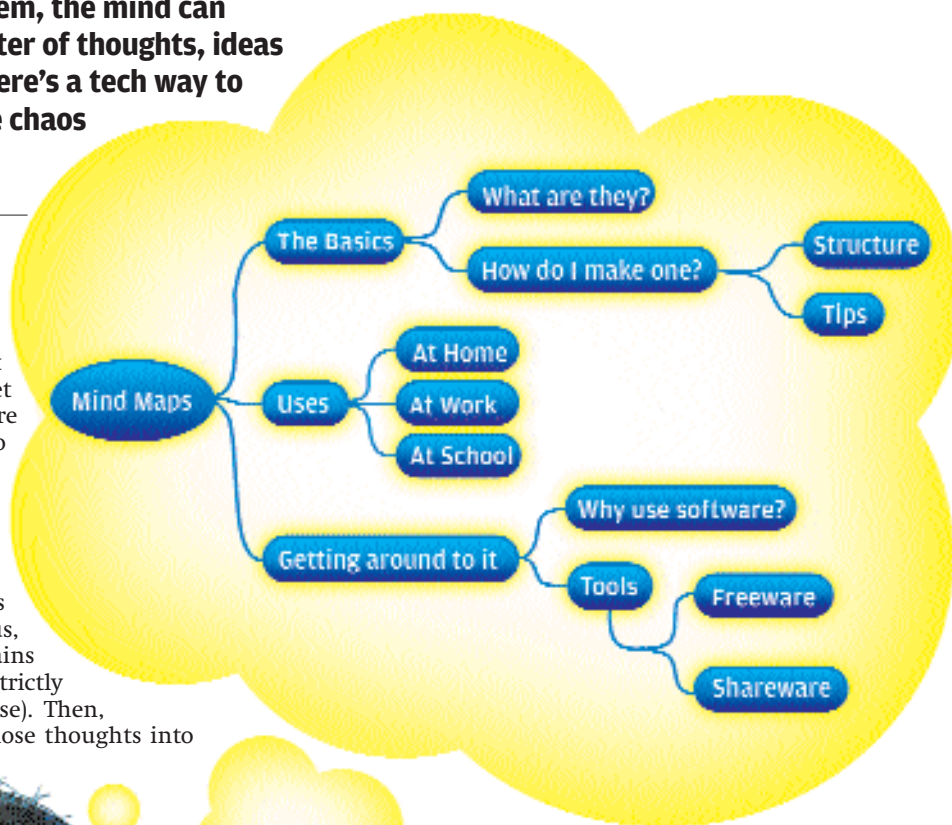
Core Dump

Faced with a new problem, the mind can become a hopeless clutter of thoughts, ideas and random rubbish. Here's a tech way to bring some order to the chaos

Nimish Chandiramani

Think about how your brain gets clogged when you're halfway into a problem. You know enough to keep you going; but you don't know enough to be able to get to the answer right away. There are so many different aspects to think of, so many different lines of thought!

Sure, there are a blessed few whose brains are built like libraries—everything is classified, categorised, and put in its place just so. For the rest of us, well, we'd like to see our brains splattered in front of us (in a strictly non-mafia-hit sense, of course). Then, perhaps, we could sort all those thoughts into



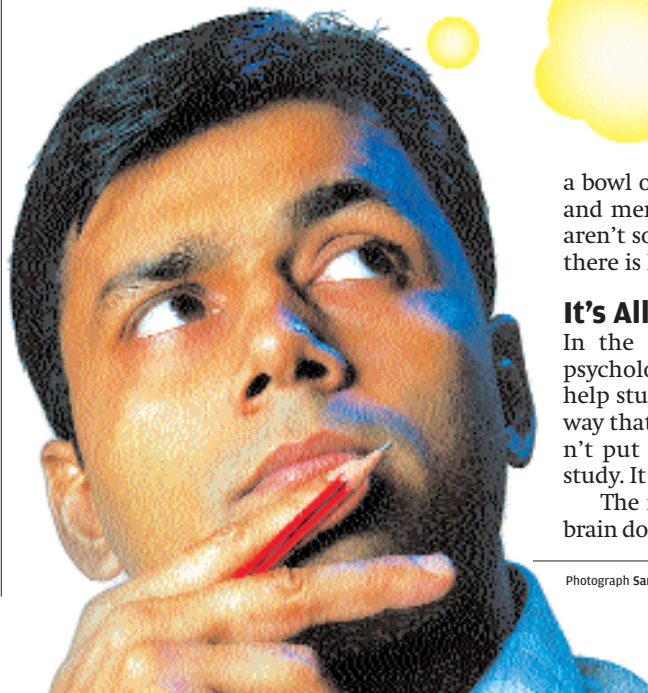
neat little piles and make sense of them.

In the Harry Potter books, Albus Dumbledore uses a "Penseive"—a bowl of sorts—into which he puts his thoughts and memories for quick and easy reference. We aren't so lucky as to have magic on our side, but there is hope for us yet.

It's All In Your Head

In the 1960s, Tony Buzan, a British popular psychology author, popularized a technique to help students take down their lecture notes in a way that was quick, easy to read, and that wouldn't put them to sleep when the time came to study. It was called the mind map.

The idea behind the mind map was that the brain doesn't think in one straight line—it starts at



Photograph Sandeep Patil